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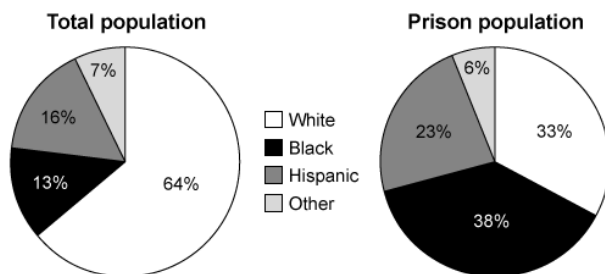


Figure 1 Total population and prison population by race and ethnicity in the United States in 2010

Research suggests that black and white people use drugs at similar rates, but black people are more likely to end up in the criminal justice system for drug use. This overrepresentation of black people in the prison population can be partly explained by discrimination at the individual and institutional levels. For example, if police departments focus their resources in predominantly black neighborhoods based on the assumption that black individuals are more likely to commit a crime, then police officers (who may similarly believe black people commit more crimes than white people) are more likely to witness black people committing crimes, thereby confirming the belief. Discrimination operates at every level of the criminal justice system: Black people are more likely than white people to be arrested, prosecuted, and convicted for drug use and receive, on average, longer sentences.

High rates of recidivism also perpetuate the demographic disparity of the prison population. It is estimated that about 75% of released prisoners will be rearrested within five years. Experts suggest that, once convicted of a felony, individuals find that their status as a former felon (or "ex-convict") dominates all their other statuses, making it difficult to reintegrate into society. The social stigma of criminality makes it hard for ex-convicts to secure employment, which often leads to further crime. Ex-convicts are also more closely monitored by police and far more likely to be arrested and convicted for minor offenses.

According to the passage, the "war on drugs" made drug use and distribution:

- ☐ A. less taboo through the implementation of more informal sanctions. [1%]
-  ☒ B. more taboo through the implementation of more formal sanctions. [85%]
- ☐ C. less of a folkway through the implementation of more informal sanctions. [2%]
- ☐ D. more of a folkway through the implementation of more formal sanctions. [10%]

Correct

85% answered correctly

Explanation:

Type of norm	Degree of deviance	Social repercussions
Folkways (eg, wearing clothes backward)	Least deviant	Minor punishments (eg, staring)
Mores (eg, wearing no clothes in public)	More deviant	More serious punishment (eg, arrest)
Taboos (eg, incest, suicide)	Most deviant	Most serious punishment (eg, incarceration)

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Norms exist in every culture and serve to disseminate information about appropriate conduct in a variety of situations. **Deviance** is any behavior that **violates** culturally established **norms**. Deviant behavior can be viewed as simply odd or off-putting (eg, nose-picking in public) or can be viewed as egregious or criminal (eg, murder).

Taboos are deviant behaviors considered **morally reprehensible** by society. Committing a taboo often results in a **formal sanction**, the application of an **institutional response**, such as arrest or incarceration. Since the "war on drugs" beginning in the 1980s, the use and distribution of drugs has become increasingly treated as not only deviant, but reprehensible and criminal in the U.S., and was increasingly met with formal sanctions (eg, jail time).

(Choice A) Informal sanctions are individual responses not codified into laws, such as disapproving looks or comments. The "war on drugs" resulted in more aggressive laws against drug use and distribution, which describes more formal (not informal) sanctions.

(Choice C) Folkways are less formal social norms that, when violated (eg, wearing clothes backward), typically result in informal sanctions (eg, raised eyebrows). The "war on drugs" did result in drug-related behaviors being viewed as less of a folkway (more taboo), but it also increased formal (not informal)

sanctions.

(Choice D) The passage explains that drug use and distribution came to be considered a higher level of deviance than it was prior to the "war on drugs," suggesting that drug-related behaviors became more taboo, not more of a folkway.

Educational objective:

Taboos are the most serious form of deviance—acts considered illegal and/or reprehensible by society. These forms of deviance meet with the most serious types of disapproval in the form of institutionalized, or formal, sanctions, such as arrest and incarceration.

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:401369

System:
Identity and Social Interaction

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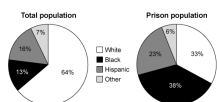
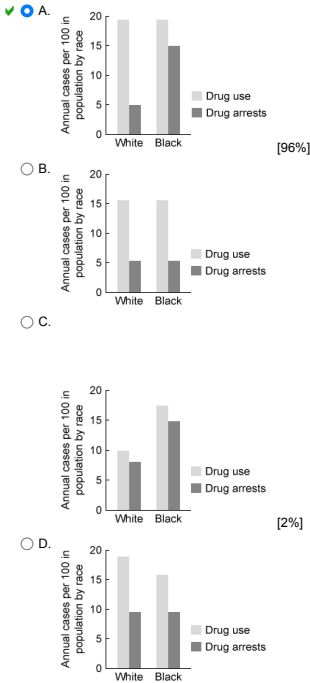


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Which of the following hypothetical data would provide support for the type of institutional discrimination described in the passage?



Correct
95% answered correctly

Explanation:

Institutional discrimination



Unfair treatment of an individual based on group membership by society/social institutions

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Institutional discrimination concerns a **social institution's** inherent **policies/procedures** that result in unequal treatment on the basis of an individual's group membership. If police department policies (rather than individual officers' decisions) cause resources (eg, patrol officers) to be focused in predominantly black neighborhoods, this would be an example of institutional discrimination.

Even though white and black people use drugs at similar rates, an increased police presence in black neighborhoods results in more blacks being arrested for drug use. The graph in **Choice A** represents equal rates of drug use among whites and blacks, but higher rates of drug arrests for blacks. This reflects institutional discrimination: Policies at the organizational level lead to higher rates of arrest for blacks.

(Choice B) Although it is true that black and white people use drugs at similar rates, an equal number of arrests of whites and blacks does *not* reflect unequal treatment based on group membership (discrimination).

(Choice C) According to the passage, blacks do not use drugs at higher rates than do whites. Higher rates of use for blacks could account for higher arrest rates, which would not reflect institutional discrimination.

(Choice D) Whites do not use drugs at higher rates than blacks. Although this may reflect institutional discrimination (lower usage rates, but equal arrest rates for blacks, meaning a higher percent of users arrested), the passage states that white and black usage rates are equal.

Educational objective:

Institutional discrimination describes patterns of unequal treatment of individuals based on their group membership. Institutional discrimination occurs at the organizational level due to differential treatment built into laws and policies.

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Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:401370
System:
Identity and Social Interaction

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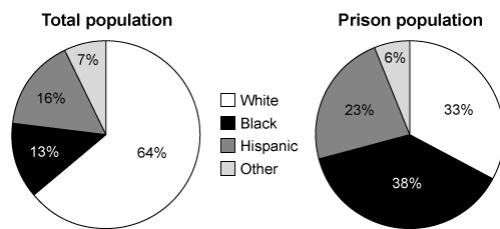


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As described in the second paragraph, disparities in prison demographics may be explained by all of the following, EXCEPT:

- ☐ A. prejudice. [9%]
- ✓ ☒ B. stereotype boost. [72%]
- ☐ C. discrimination. [1%]
- ☐ D. confirmation bias. [16%]

Correct

73% answered correctly

Explanation:

Stereotype boost (also known as stereotype lift) occurs when *positive* stereotypes about social

groups cause improved performance. For example, Asians reminded of the stereotype "Asians are good at math" before completing a math test tend to outperform Asians who are not first reminded of this stereotype. This passage does not discuss improved performance as a result of a positive stereotype.

Prejudice refers to preconceived **ideas** and **beliefs** about people or groups based on their group membership. **Discrimination** is the **unequal treatment** of individuals or groups on the basis of group membership.

Confirmation bias is a type of cognitive bias (common error in thinking) in which individuals tend to **embrace evidence supporting** their beliefs, dismiss or ignore evidence refuting their beliefs, and interpret ambiguous evidence as support. Prejudice may cause an individual to act in a discriminatory fashion, creating the conditions for confirmation bias.

(Choices A, C, and D) A police officer who believes black people commit more crimes (prejudice) and who spends the majority of his time patrolling predominantly black neighborhoods (discrimination) is more likely to witness black people than white people committing crimes, which *confirms his original belief* (confirmation bias).

Educational objective:

Prejudice is having a preconceived belief about individuals or groups based on their group membership. Discrimination is treating people unequally on the basis of group membership. Confirmation bias occurs when individuals accept evidence supporting their beliefs and dismiss evidence refuting their beliefs.

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Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:401371
System:
Identity and Social Interaction

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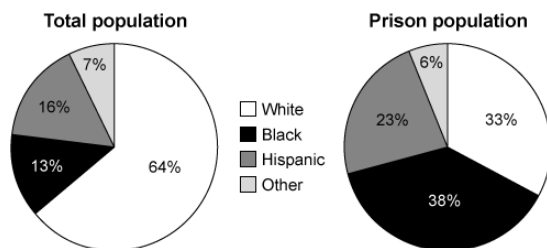


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According to the experts cited in the third paragraph, "ex-convict" is best described as what type of status?

- ☒ A. Master [58%]
- ☐ B. Ascribed [34%]
- ☐ C. Socioeconomic [6%]

Correct

59% answered correctly

Explanation:

Ascribed status	Assigned social position (eg, race)
Achieved status	Attained social position (eg, doctor)
Master status	Dominant social position (eg, ex-convict)

Relative to others in society, individuals hold social status positions, which are ascribed or achieved. An **ascribed status** is one that is socially **assigned**, such as race. An **achieved status** is one that is **attained**, such as one's occupation (eg, doctor), notable achievements (eg, Olympic athlete), or failures (eg, college dropout).

Individuals may hold many ascribed and achieved statuses, but their **master status** is the one that **dominates** in social situations. A master status can be either ascribed or achieved, may be context-dependent, and tends to influence most aspects of one's social life.

The experts cited in the third paragraph suggest that, once convicted of a felony, individuals find that their status as a former felon (or "ex-convict") dominates all their other statuses, which describes a *master status*.

(Choice B) Ex-convict is a status that is attained through one's actions, so it would be considered an achieved status, not an ascribed status.

(Choice C) Socioeconomic status defines one's standing in society based on income (wealth), education, and occupation. A status that dominates all of one's other statuses, like that of ex-convict, is best defined as a master status, not a socioeconomic status.

(Choice D) Generational status refers to whether individuals were born in the country in which they reside. For example, an individual who was born in the United States but whose parents were born in Mexico has a generational status of "first-generation American." Ex-convict is not considered a generational status.

Educational objective:

Master status, which is either ascribed (assigned) or achieved (attained), dominates in most social situations and thereby tends to influence most aspects of one's social life.

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Behavioral Sciences

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Identity and Social Interaction

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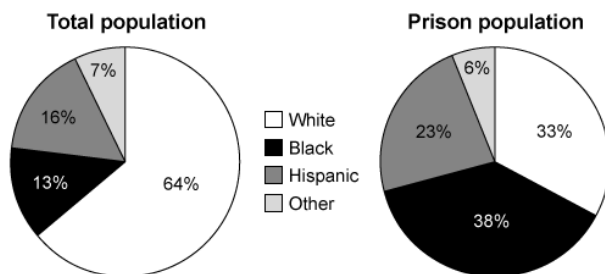


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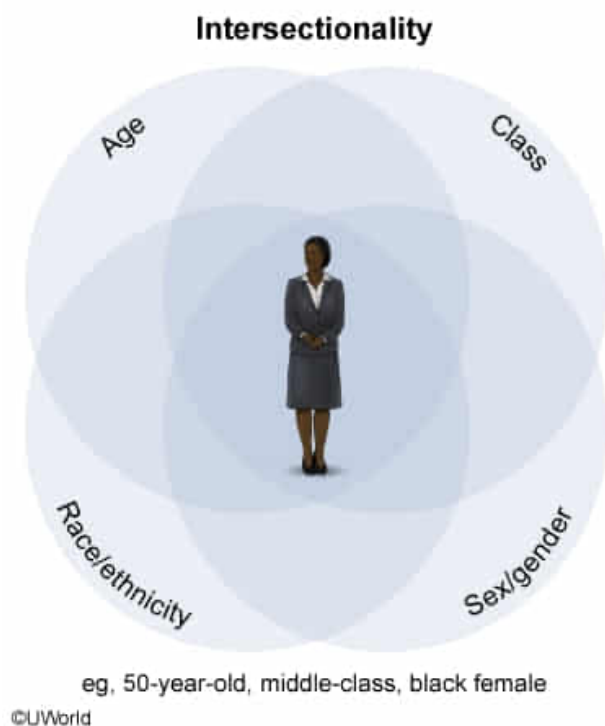
Which of the following helps explain the demographic disparities of the prison population described in the passage?

- ☐ A. Social reproduction, because a child whose parent has been incarcerated is more likely to stay away from criminal activities. [3%]
- ☐ B. Occupational prestige, because individuals with higher-paying, professional jobs are not motivated to commit crime. [27%]
- ☐ C. Social capital, because females are more likely to have contacts in the criminal justice system who can get them released without a conviction. [2%]
- ✓ ☒ D. Intersectionality, because white males are more likely to be incarcerated than black females, but less likely than black males. [66%]

Correct

67% answered correctly

Explanation:



The **intersectionality** approach describes how all **individuals** hold **multiple, interconnected identities** that simultaneously **impact** their **lives** and **perspectives**. For example, being female is not the only identity that affects how a woman sees, experiences, or is treated in the world. Her experiences and perspectives are also a product of her other identities (eg, race/ethnicity, class, sexual orientation).

With respect to incarceration, the U.S. prison population is both disproportionately black *and* disproportionately male, placing individuals who are black and male at

the intersection of statuses most represented in prisons. Although white males are more likely to be incarcerated than black females, black males are more likely to be imprisoned than white males.

(Choice A) Social reproduction refers to the transmission of society's values, norms, and practices, including social inequality, from one generation to the next. Children with a parent who has been incarcerated are more (not less) likely to be incarcerated themselves. The passage does not mention generational effects on prison demographics.

(Choice B) Occupational prestige is a measure of the respect and esteem (prestige) of a given occupation. Occupations requiring the most education are generally ranked highest. However, the passage does not mention occupational status or prestige.

(Choice C) Social capital refers to one's social network and the value of those connections. Although one may have connections in the criminal justice system who can impact outcomes, the example given here addresses only sex/gender disparities. Racial disparities are more emphasized in the passage, and both racial and sex/gender disparities are accounted for with intersectionality.

Educational objective:

An intersectional analysis argues that people hold several statuses (group memberships) simultaneously, which must be considered together in understanding an individual's overall perspective and experience. An individual does not operate simply based on race, gender, or any other social identity alone, but more specifically as (for example) a young black male, a white heterosexual female, or a working-class Hispanic female.

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Behavioral Sciences

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System:
Identity and Social Interaction

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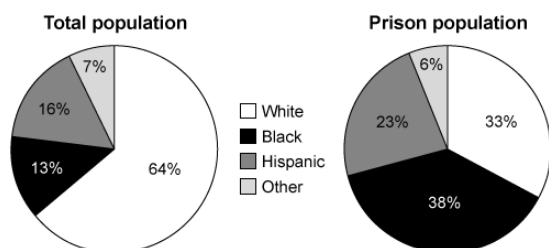


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Recidivism as discussed in the final paragraph can best be explained by which of the following theories?

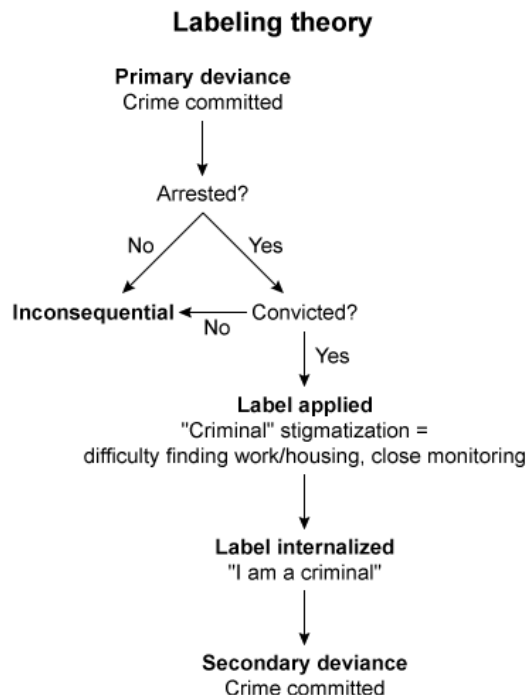
- ☐ A. Differential association [7%]
- ✓ ☒ B. Labeling [84%]
- ☐ C. Conflict [5%]

☐ D. Rational choice [2%]

Correct

84% answered correctly

Explanation:



Labeling theory suggests that when someone is labeled as **deviant**, the act of **being labeled** produces **further deviance**. The initial act is called primary deviance and, if labeled, results in social stigma such as disapproval by others. Internalization of the deviant label leads to further acts of deviance, called secondary deviance.

If an individual is convicted of a crime and labeled a criminal, employment and housing become more difficult, and police are more likely to monitor the individual's activities. These obstacles facilitate the individual's internalization of the label "criminal," making it more likely that person will commit another crime and be caught again. So the response to actions (labeling and social stigma), not the initial actions themselves, creates deviance.

(Choice A) Differential association theory suggests that deviance is learned through interaction. For example, someone goes to prison for drug possession and learns from incarcerated sellers how to efficiently sell drugs. The passage does not discuss learning criminal behaviors from others.

(Choice C) Conflict theory suggests that laws are created to serve those in power and maintain their privilege. Individuals engage in deviance as political protest against inequalities. The passage does not suggest recidivism is a conscious choice to act in ways to subvert the current social order.

(Choice D) According to rational choice theory, people act to maximize gain and minimize loss. For example, an individual weighs the benefits of acting deviantly against the likelihood of getting caught (cost) before acting. The passage does not mention a

cost/benefit decision-making process.

Educational objective:

Labeling theory suggests that deviance lies not in the act but in the social response of applying a label to individuals. Labeling individuals as deviant has consequences, such as stigmatization, that lead to further deviance.

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:401374

System:
Identity and Social Interaction